

copper coins, 6,662,188 marks.

Madame Stroussberg, an Englishwoman, travelled to Moscow with one of her sons, to obtain freedom for her husband, and meanwhile, on the 15th, the assembly of creditors, with a view to debate on the bankrupt estate, took place at Berlin. In this assembly the administrator of the estate, chosen by the creditors, gave a short history of Stroussberg's industrial undertakings since the year 1870, from which we extract the following facts. Stroussberg stood on the zenith of his career in 1870. At that very time he was constructing the Roumanian railways, the Hungarian North-Eastern line, the railways between Halle and Sorau, between the Mark and Posen, Hanover and Altenbecken, Brest and Irajewo. He was building the works of Dortmund, those of Neustadt, besides other establishments. He had several other railway concessions ready in his pocket. He had built the cattle market of Berlin, bought the machine manufactory of Hanover. Besides, he had acquired the citadelle of Antwerp by paying down three-and-a-half million francs. In the midst of all this activity the war broke out, and with it came losses of millions and great financial difficulties. Yet Stroussberg tried to get over it all, and really succeeded in delivering the railways between the Mark and Posen, a part of the Roumanian, and the line between Halle, Sorau, and Guben, over to public use. And yet he had suffered immense losses by the disadvantageous sale of the railway shares by which he had been paid, and by the subscribers of the Brest-Grajewo line having stopped payment altogether. He received a severe blow from the Roumanian Government, which refused to pay the coupons due in January, 1871. As a means of furnishing the two million thalers necessary in this emergency, Stroussberg tried to found the "General German Company for Railway Construction." This, however, failed, the January coupons could not be paid, and Stroussberg's credit was undermined.

Then he tried an escape by having a Roumanian Railway Company founded by Bleichröder and the "Discount Society." The Roumanian railway took upon itself all Stroussberg's

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many up to the 18,262,380 marks in silver coins, 197 marks; in

ravelled to Mos- for her husband, reditors, with a place at Berlin. state, chosen by berg's industrial

obligations, against an indemnity of 6 million thalers. Two millions were got up by the sale of the works in Dortmund, 2 millions were borrowed from the "Society," for which the German mines and the whole property of Zbirow were offered as a security, the last 2 millions were borrowed on the security of his German possessions. He now owed the Roumania Com- pany 1.6 millions besides, and the Discount Society 1.3 mil- lions. With a view to further consolidation, Stroussberg in 1872 sold the machine manufactory in Hanover, the cattle market in Berlin, the works in Neustadt, and the iron and coal mines in the Siegener Land. He gave the North-Eastern Railway in Hungary up to the Union Bank, and renounced his several other railway conces- sions, by which means he, of course, lost all the enormous sums deposited. All he retained was the continuation of the lines between Brest-Grajewo, Halle-Sorau, Hanover- Altenbecken. He then concentrated all the means he could dispose of, in making use of the Zbirow property, upon which he built machine and railway-car manufactories, furnaces, &c., &c., and by this means established, perhaps, one of the most important industrial "complexes" in existence. The consequences were, however, renewed difficulties. He went to England, and there tried to found an establishment, but failed in the trial. He again returned to Germany, seeking new means by selling his picture-gallery, by giving up his Antwerp concession and the construction of the line Hanover- Altenbecken. The lines Halle-Sorau and Brest-Grajewo had meanwhile been finished. In 1874 Stroussberg signed a treaty with the Russian Paliakoff—the treaty in which he promises to furnish 2,000 railway wagons and cars. The cars were destined for the Kursk-Charkow line, and were paid for with obligations of that railway, which were deposited against a loan at the Commerce and Loan Bank in Moscow. After having furnished these railway cars to satisfaction, he signed a new contract for 2,000 more, for which the above-mentioned bank gave him a loan of 1.8 million roubles. At the commencement of the year Stroussberg had bought back, not only the works of Neustadt and Siegen, but also the works "Marienhutte" in Danzig. Stroussberg's bankruptcy broke up the following industrial enterprises:—1. The railway between Melthow and Weida acquired at the commencement of the year 1875 for 1,700,000 thalers (1 million shares, the rest debentures). Both shares and debentures cannot be sold. 2. The rail- way through the Waagthal, acquired for 6,480,000 gulden and almost finished. The administration of the bankrupt's stock hopes to sell the 7½ per cent. obligations advantageously, as soon as the line is entirely completed. 3. The railway from Paris to Narbonne. The greatest part has only been measured, and a very short line has been begun, the distance between Bourget and Beaune-la-Rolande. To acquire the right of continuation of this line from the French Government 500,000 francs must be added to the sums already deposited. Stroussberg's last enterprise is the mysterious foundation of a "Shareholder's Company for German and Bohemian iron and steel manufactories," upon which Stroussberg conferred his Bohemian works and mines, at the price of 37,000,000 marks. The capital consists of 15 million marks in shares, and a many debentures. This company takes upon itself 7 million marks of mortgages. Almost all the shares go into Strouss- berg's hands. He is general leaseholder, only shareholder and at the same time sole controller of the company—the ad- ministration of the bankrupt's estate, therefore, have a right to doubt the existence of this society altogether.

Before concluding the history of Stroussberg's enterprise since 1870, the administrator mentions all the data respecting the assets of the bankrupt. There are thirteen separate properties in Prussia. They are the following:—Radau, Womwelo, Alt-Laube, Priebisch and Gowthe, Lissa, and Warienen, Diepensee and Waltersdorff, Mohozl, Namburg. Besides, there is his palace in Berlin, Wilhelmsstrasse No. 70, a house in the vicinity of the Thiergarten, a villa and garden in the Thiergartenstrasse, and a number of great estates. The administrator is of opinion that the rumours respecting Mrs Stroussberg's enormous fortune are very much exaggerated; she has already given up almost all her property to her husband. (?) The railway-car manufactory in Elbing was registered in her name, but the administration has disclaimed it, and hopes that she will give it up willingly. As to the working of the enterprises, it has been stopped at the establishments of industry, whilst on the agricultural property it is still going on. The "Discount Commission" which is bound up most in the business, has offered to advance the necessary funds. The administrator finally declares that the personal presence of Stroussberg is very much to be desired, and advises the creditors to demand that he should be set free. This has, in fact, since been obtained.